Questweight Studios

By: Jeremy Offutt & Curtis Mortensen

GRAPHIC PLACEHOLDER

Dragons & Dice Rolls

Heroic Chaos Without the Homework

d4 d6 d8 d10 d12 D20

SECTION 1: QUICKSTART GUIDE

1.1 Welcome to Beginner's School

Dice & Dragons is a fast-paced, cooperative storytelling game where you and your friends compose an epic adventure together. It can be as ridiculous or serious as your table wants it to be. If you have ever wanted the best parts of traditional tabletop roleplaying games - slaying dragons, delivering dramatic speeches, and collecting cool loot - without committing years of your life or performing endless homework, you are in the right place.

Golden Rule of Tone

Choose a shared tone: comedy, epic fantasy, or anything in between. Not as a rule - just a way to keep everyone aiming for the same vibe.

1.2 Automated Setup for Your First Adventure

To learn the game by playing immediately, set it up as in the picture. Put all decks of cards in the center of the table.

GRAPHIC PLACEHOLDER

Pass the Character Mats and Backgrounds around the table. Each player chooses exactly one of each:

1. **Select a Class Mat:** Choose from Force of Nature, Tactician, Rapscallion, Meat Shield, Pack Leader, or Minstrel. Grab the specific class dice assigned to your Class Mat line.
2. **Select a Background Card:** Place it directly onto its designated slot on your Class Mat.
3. **Fill Your Hearts:** Take the starting Heart tokens shown on your Class Mat and place them into the heart-shaped slots.
4. **Acquire Your Signature Item:** Deal 3 Item cards to each player. Replace any red- or green-bordered card; only basic items can be signature items at the start. Choose one permanent, iconic Signature Item and discard the other two.

Choosing Strategy

Choose the most versatile item - one useful in combat, diplomacy, and puzzles. Barring that, choose a combat item.

5. **Draw Your Starting Gear:** Draw one additional Item card. If its skill tags match a skill printed on your Class Mat or Background, keep it. Otherwise return it and draw until you find an item you can legally wield.

Backpack Comfort

Equip up to 4 Items at a time. Your Signature Item does not count against this limit. Unequipped Items remain in your unlimited backpack.

1.3 Introducing Your Character

Pick a Name and draw a Flashback Prompt. Introduce yourself in character: How did an ordinary person with your Background become a legendary member of your Class, and how did you acquire your Signature Item? Use your Prompt for inspiration and tell the story in first person.

When another player finishes, applaud their effort. Give them one of your color's Applause Tokens. Helping them does not hurt you.

1.4 The Opening Scene & Choosing a Goal

Choose a Party Goal. As a group, decide what grand objective your adventure is trying to accomplish. This goal keeps everyone moving in the same direction.

The youngest player becomes the first Architect, serving as narrator and game master for the opening quest. Give them the Architect Token.

1.5 Quest 1: Secure a Happy Ever After

1. **Read the introduction:** The Architect draws "Secure a Happy Ever After" and reads the description aloud.
2. **Read the first scenario:** Help the royal lover sort out their complicated feelings to reveal the NPC the party must persuade.
3. **Set the Challenge:** Draw 1-3 Challenge Cards and hand them to players. Each recipient explains how their Challenge makes the Quest harder.
4. **Deal:** Give every player except the Architect 3 white Diplomacy Cards. The Architect draws and reads a blue NPC Card.
5. **Submit:** Each player secretly chooses 1 Diplomacy Card. Add random cards equal to the Challenge Rating, then shuffle the pile.
6. **Activate an Item (optional):** Spend 1 Applause Token, describe a brief flashback about the gear, and resolve its effect.
7. **The Architect's Verdict:** Reveal and read every submitted card. Choose the outcome that best fits the negotiation.

Success: If a player's card is chosen, the party persuades the NPC. Narrate the success and how it leads to the next Quest.

Failure: If an added card is chosen, competing interests, misinformation, or bad luck win the day. Narrate what went wrong and how the party moves on.

8. **Rewards:** On success, deal 1 Item Card to each player. Then draw Item Cards equal to twice the Challenge Rating and distribute them among the party.

1.6 Running Combat: Fend Off Other Suitors

1. **Present the threat:** Read "Fend off other suitors."
2. **Choose monsters:** Draw or pick a monster to act as the suitors. Have fun explaining why.
3. **Set the Challenge:** Draw 1-3 Challenge Cards. Players explain why those complications belong in the story.
4. **Build the encounter:** Use the Monster Manual pages and the total difficulty on the Challenge Cards. Place the appropriate Hearts on each monster.
5. **Monsters attack first:** Roll the attack die in the stat block and compare it to the target's Defense. Meeting the Defense deals the listed damage.
6. **Players act:** In clockwise order, choose a Basic Attack, Activate an Item, or Charge.
7. **Continue rounds:** After every player acts, the monsters attack again. Continue until all monsters or all heroes are defeated.
8. **Rewards:** On success, use the same reward procedure as the Diplomacy Quest.

Heroic Actions

Once per combat, when you would lose your final Heart, return every Applause Token you hold to its owner. Stay standing with half a Heart instead.

1.7 Downtime and Rotating Roles

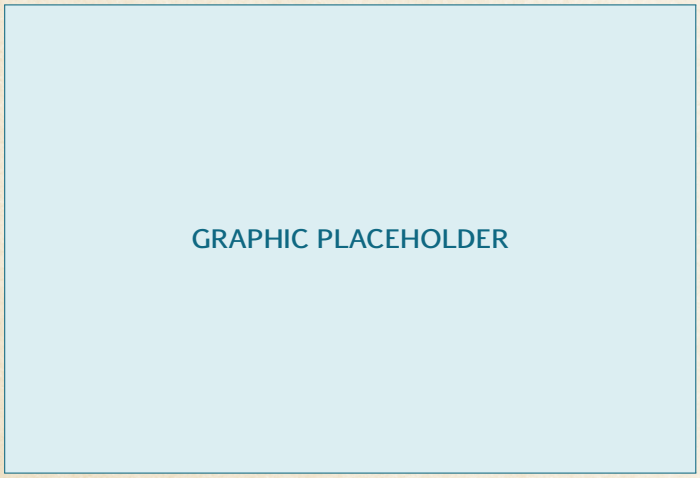
After Quest 1, every player heals half a Heart, players may trade Items, and the Architect Token passes to the player on the left.

1.8 Part 2, Quest 1: Combat

The new Architect leads the second part of the Quest. Monsters act first. On a player turn, a Basic Attack automatically deals half a Heart, an Item costs an Applause Token and a flashback, and Charge spends a token now to double the next attack's damage.

2.0 Quest 2: Help a Dragon Fall Asleep

Pass the Architect Token. Run "Help a Dragon Fall Asleep," featuring a Puzzle Challenge instead of diplomacy.



1. **Read the description:** Perform a bedtime story.
2. **Draw Challenges:** Pass out Challenge Cards and let players explain them.
3. **Set up the encounter:** Play Knucklebones as described in Section 5.
4. **Narrate the ending:** Explain how success advances the Party Goal or how failure creates a setback.
5. **Pass out rewards:** Use the normal reward procedure.

2.1 Downtime

Pass the Architect Token and trade Items if desired. Keep in mind that the next Quest is combat: despite your bedtime story, noisy creatures still need attention.

2.2 Combat

Combat works the same as "Fend Off Other Suitors." For edge cases, use Section 4.5.

2.3 Finish

Congratulations! You have survived Beginner's School. You now know Quests, Flashbacks, Items, Challenges, Diplomacy, Puzzles, and Combat. Continue these heroes or start fresh with a new party.

SECTION 3: COMPREHENSIVE PLAYER REFERENCE RULES

Keep this section accessible in the center of the table as a shared system reference guide during active gameplay.

3.1 Standard Game Setup & Campaign Scaling

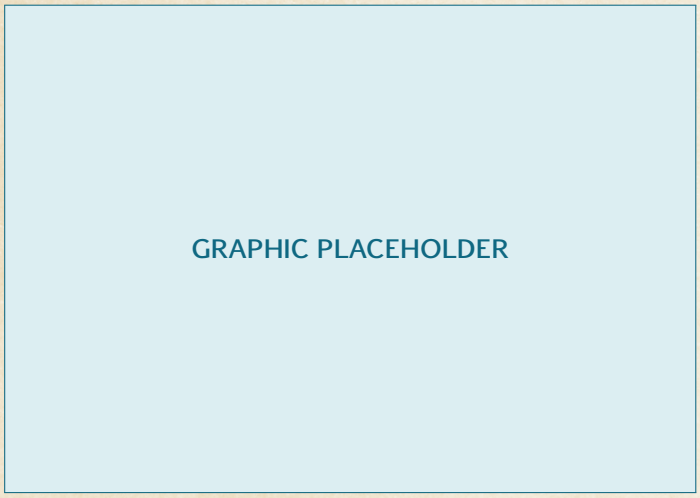
Decide how many Quests you would like to play, then build a Quest deck of that size.

Short Adventure: 2 Quests
Medium Adventure: 3 Quests
Long Adventure: 5 Quests

New groups should expect their first few games to take longer as they learn the rules and develop their storytelling style.

3.3 Reading Your Class Mat

Your Class Mat is your character's home base. It tracks your unique Class Ability, Background, Applause to use, Signature Item, equipped Items, and health throughout the game.



3.4 Applause Tokens

Applause Tokens reward players for making the story more entertaining. Whenever someone makes the table laugh, tells a memorable flashback, or describes a particularly cool moment, toss them one of your Applause Tokens.

Your own tokens are worthless to you. To use your Class Ability, Signature Item, or an equipped Item, spend an Applause Token received from another player.

You may hold up to 5 Applause Tokens from other players. If a player at the limit would receive one, reward another player who helped make the moment memorable. When spent, return it to the player whose color it matches.

3.5 Gear & Equipment Architecture

All Items are activated the same way: spend an Applause Token, describe a brief flashback, and resolve the card's effects.

Most Items require at least one matching Skill Tag shown on your Background Card. If an Item has no Skill Tags, any character may use it.

Signature Items are equipped in the Signature Slot and represent iconic gear. They are never discarded after use and ignore all Skill Tag requirements.

Items come in three types:

- **Basic Items (Blue):** Standard equipment and tools.
- **Rare Items (Red):** More powerful and unusual effects.
- **Instant Items (Green):** May be played during another player's or an enemy's turn and do not count against the normal item activation limit.

SECTION 4: THE ARCHITECT'S SCROLL (GAME MASTER GUIDE)

The player currently holding the Architect Token should have this section of the rulebook.

4.1 The Pillars of Architecture

As the Game Architect, your word is final - but your primary job is to protect the table's collective fun, not win tactical arguments. Commit these laws to memory:

- **Rule 1: Guard Table Enjoyment.** Keep every player engaged, especially quieter people.
- **Rule 2: Refer Directly to Rule 1.**
- **Rule 3: Momentum Over Correctness.** If a rules question slows the story, make a quick ruling and keep moving. Look up the official answer later.

The Narrative Trick

Use isolated, vivid sensory details instead of long lore. Choose one anchor: smell (ozone, wet rot), sound (distant rhythmic chanting), or texture (grit between teeth). If stuck, ask a player what happens next, then build on the answer.

Failure Example

The jungle quest fails one hero at a time, but the party wakes in a dungeon that smells like rotting flesh: the necromancer's fortress. Failure changed the path instead of ending the story.

4.2 Ending a Quest

Reveal all cards and read them aloud. Choose the outcome that creates the most entertaining, dramatic, surprising, or satisfying continuation. There is no single correct answer.

Success: The party persuades the NPC, defeats the monster, or solves the puzzle. Narrate how success leads to the next Quest.

Failure: The negotiation fails, trap triggers, or monsters defeat the party. Narrate the setback and redirect the party toward the next Quest.

Rewards: Deal 1 Item Card to each player, then draw additional Item Cards equal to twice the Challenge Rating and distribute them among the party.

4.3 Running Diplomacy Quests

1. **Present the NPC:** Draw an NPC Card and introduce the character the party must persuade.
2. **Set the Challenge:** Draw 1-3 Challenge Cards. Each player explains how their Challenge complicates the Quest.
3. **Deal:** Give every player except the Architect 3 Diplomacy Cards.
4. **Submit:** Each player submits 1 card. Add random cards equal to the Challenge Rating and shuffle.
5. **Activate Items:** Players may activate Items normally. Table talk is encouraged: discuss, negotiate, argue, joke, and advocate.
6. **The Architect's Verdict:** Read all cards and choose the outcome that best continues the story.

4.5 Running Combat Quests

Combat Quests are cooperative battles where the party races to defeat all monsters before the monsters defeat the party.

1. **Set Up the Encounter:** Place the required Monster Cards and set their health from the stat blocks.
2. **Monsters Act:** Monsters always act first. Roll the attack die, compare it to the target's Defense, and deal listed damage on a hit.
3. **Players Act:** Starting left of the Architect, each player takes one turn: Basic Attack for half a Heart, Activate an Item, or Charge to double the next attack.
4. **Instant Items:** Green Items may be played outside a turn when their trigger occurs and do not consume the turn's action.
5. **Repeat:** Alternate monster and player turns until one side is defeated.

Victory: Resolve the Quest normally and gain rewards.
Defeat: Resolve the Quest as a failure. Defeated heroes recover to half health before the next Quest.

> **Want More Adventures?**
>
> We are expanding the game with new quests, items, challenges, and digital tools. Visit `www.questweight.com`.

5.0 THE PUZZLE MINIGAME VAULT

When players choose a puzzle resolution path, the Architect operates as the obstacle and uses the standard cooperative game format.

Knucklebones

Knucklebones resolves Puzzle Quests. It can represent picking a lock, disabling a magical trap, unraveling an ancient ritual, or overcoming any obstacle requiring wit rather than force.

The Architect plays against the party. If the party wins every active Knucklebones board, the Quest succeeds. If the Architect wins even one board, the Quest fails.

Setup

Each side receives a board of 3 columns with 3 spaces each. The Architect starts with a 6 in the center square. All participants use standard d6s.

For groups of 4 or more players, the Architect assigns a helper and runs a second board simultaneously. The party must win both boards.

Before play, cover Class Powers equal to the current Challenge Rating. Covered powers cannot be used during the puzzle.

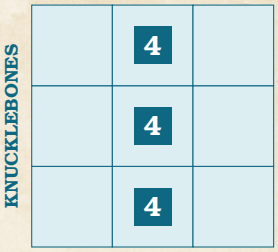
Taking Turns

The Architect takes the first turn. On your turn:

1. Roll a d6.
2. Place the die into any column on your board.
3. Optionally use an Item or Class Ability.

Any player may spend Applause Tokens, activate Items, or use available Class Abilities to assist any party board.

> **Keep the Puzzle Alive**
> Describe the puzzle as the board changes. A removed die can be a lock tumbler clicking into place, a rune fading, or part of a ritual circle collapsing.



Scoring

When the game ends, each die is worth its face value. Matching dice in the same column multiply their value:

- Two matching dice are worth double each die's value.
- Three matching dice are worth triple each die's value.

A column containing 5, 5 is worth 20 points. A column containing 4, 4, 4 is worth 24 points.

Removing Opponent Dice

When you place a die into a column, remove one matching die from the same column on your opponent's board.

> **Knucklebones Tip**
> Removing an opponent's high-value dice is often more powerful than adding points to your own board.

Winning the Puzzle

The game ends when either side fills all 9 spaces. Calculate both scores. Higher score wins; ties favor the Architect. The party must win every active board. Resolve success, failure, and rewards as described in Section 4.2.

MONSTER MANUAL

For combat, choose the page based on the number of players: 2 or 4 players use the first set; 3, 5, or 6 players use the second. Two or three players fight one monster, or two at difficulty 4 or 5. Four or more players fight twice the listed count.

2 OR 4 PLAYERS

Basic Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 4.5; roll 1d10; damage 1.5	1x
2 HP 4.5; roll 1d8+2; damage 2.0	1x
3 HP 4.5; roll 1d10+1; damage 3.0	1x
4 HP 2.5; roll 1d4+2; damage 2.0	2x
5 HP 2.5; roll 1d4+2; damage 2.5	2x

Powerful Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 4.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 2.0	1x
2 HP 4.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 3.5	1x
3 HP 4.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 5.0	1x
4 HP 2.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 3.0	2x
5 HP 2.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 3.5	2x

Acid Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 4.5; roll 1d20-4; damage 1.0	1x
2 HP 4.5; roll 1d10; damage 1.5	1x
3 HP 4.5; roll 1d10; damage 2.0	1x
4 HP 2.5; roll 1d12+2; damage 1.0	2x
5 HP 2.5; roll 1d4+2; damage 1.5	2x

Players damaged by an Acid Monster take the same damage again at the start of that monster's next turn.

Life Steal Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 4.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 1.5	1x
2 HP 4.5; roll 1d20-4; damage 2.0	1x
3 HP 4.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 3.5	1x
4 HP 2.5; roll 1d10-4; damage 4.0	2x
5 HP 2.5; roll 1d10-4; damage 4.5	2x

Life Steal Monsters heal half a Heart every time they hit.

3, 5, OR 6 PLAYERS

Basic Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 7.0; roll 1d10+1; damage 2.0	1x
2 HP 7.0; roll 1d8+2; damage 3.0	1x
3 HP 7.0; roll 1d10+1; damage 4.5	1x
4 HP 3.5; roll 1d4+2; damage 3.0	2x
5 HP 3.5; roll 1d10+1; damage 3.5	2x

Powerful Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 7.0; roll 1d4+1; damage 3.0	1x
2 HP 7.0; roll 1d4+1; damage 5.0	1x
3 HP 7.0; roll 1d4+1; damage 7.0	1x
4 HP 3.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 4.5	2x
5 HP 3.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 5.5	2x

Acid Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 7.0; roll 1d20+2; damage 1.0	1x
2 HP 7.0; roll 1d10+1; damage 2.0	1x
3 HP 7.0; roll 1d10; damage 3.0	1x
4 HP 3.5; roll 1d12+2; damage 1.5	2x
5 HP 3.5; roll 1d6+2; damage 2.0	2x

Players damaged by an Acid Monster take the same damage again at the start of that monster's next turn.

Life Steal Monsters

Rating and statistics	Count
1 HP 7.5; roll 1d10-1; damage 2.0	1x
2 HP 7.5; roll 1d20-4; damage 3.0	1x
3 HP 7.5; roll 1d6+1; damage 4.0	1x
4 HP 3.5; roll 1d12-4; damage 4.0	2x
5 HP 3.5; roll 1d4+1; damage 4.5	2x

Life Steal Monsters heal half a Heart every time they hit.